

strive to break in and understand how it works, and why it works that way. Often, instead of simply accepting things the way they are, they will look for ways to make things work the way they want. While this may be considered juvenile, hacking into someone's computer, just to see if you can, doesn't cause anyone any harm as long as you are responsible enough to respect their privacy.

Don't like the way Windows names shortcuts, hack the registry and change the way it works. Windows may not provide the facility to do this, but that is no reason for us to be limited to the way it works.

In the end, why should there be any kind of artificial limitation to what you can do with your computer? By artificial restriction we mean to say that no amount of hacking is going to make your computer do your laundry! However nothing should stop you from using your computer to its best capacity, as long as it does no one else any harm.

Most hackers are not out to steal money from banks, or crack passwords to sell them, they are there for the thrill of the ride. They will try to hack a system just to see if they can, much like picking their neighbours lock, only to lock it back again – perhaps leave a note telling them they should get a better lock.

Hacking constitutes a mind-set, not a skillset. It's not a "job" it's not something you do for a living. You may earn because of your skills as a hacker, but the hacker mindset is what makes a hacker. Like with anything else, you don't start at the top, you are willing to learn and you poke at things to see where they go; patience is important because it is unlikely you will get what you want in your first try, or your tenth.

To start with, one might simply change the obscure settings accessible to them from Windows, moving further they may install third-party applications which have common hacks for Windows. Then one might go further and change the registry themselves to experiment. The road doesn't need to end here you can start modifying the actual Windows binaries.

Note we say Windows a lot, what about Linux? Fact is, Linux is much easier to hack than Windows. Shock! Horror! Yes, we said Linux is easier to hack than Windows, but it is also considered more secure. When you look at hacking from the larger-sense perspective of messing with a system out of curiosity, Linux allows you to do more. Linux is intentionally hack-able, allowing each and every parameter to be changed by the user. You can create unique combinations of application sets and features that the distribution creators never envisioned. With Linux you have access to nearly all the source code of the system, how much more hack-friendly could it be! With Windows on the other hand, one would need to use third-party tools, patch binaries change undocumented registry settings, and even then the level of customizability would be much less.